

S05-06 - Market Correction

Player read-aloud

The runes stutter. Somewhere under the soil, something old receives permission to continue.

Scene summary

The environment produces more skeletons when pressure is needed.

Visible choices

- Spend Fear
- Summon skeletons
- Escalate ritual instability

Player questions

- What detail in Market Correction tells you the official story is incomplete?
- Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it?
- What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?

Raw source

- Id: S05-06
- Act: Act Five
- Title: Market Correction
- Beats: Corporate satire beat Combat Consequence
- Image: assets/scenes/S05-06-market-correction.png
- Short: The environment produces more skeletons when pressure is needed.
- Long: The field itself becomes an indictment: the system keeps making new problems while the heroes try to fix the old one.
- Read: The runes stutter. Somewhere under the soil, something old receives permission to continue.
- Gm: Use only if the fight needs pressure or if a Soul-Audit Wraith module effect needs a fast enemy for countdown progress.
- Entities: Market Correction Legacy Security Skeleton Open Vale? Ritual Site Soul-Audit Wraith Marlowe Fairwind Keystone Asset Whitefire Custodian Corporate Seal Wax Residue Vulnerable Ritual Countdown Route Assurance Contract Sealed Keystone Crate
- Choices: Spend Fear Summon skeletons Escalate ritual instability
- Prompt: Ritual clearing destabilizes as more skeletons tear from ground, golden ward light and cold spectral energy clash; no strixwolf, no Bramble Union.
- Source Entities: Market Correction Legacy Security Skeleton Open Vale? Ritual Site
- Beat Codes: corporate-satire-beat combat consequence
- Slug: S05-06-market-correction
- Act Title: The Ward Renewal
- Arc Role: Ordeal, ritual defense, and restoration

- Caption: Market Correction is the system trying to restore profit logic over human safety.
- Image Alt: Market Correction scene art for The Ward Renewal.
- Image Prompt Used: Ritual clearing destabilizes as more skeletons tear from ground, golden ward light and cold spectral energy clash; no strixwolf, no Bramble Union. Do not include the Strixwolf Mother, strixwolf pups, wolves, owlbeats, or animal companions unless explicitly requested. No Strixwolf. No Bramble Union. Only Legacy Security Skeletons and Soul-Audit Wraiths as threats. 4:3 cinematic fantasy concept art, no visible text, no captions, no logos, no UI, no watermark.
- Long Storyboard: The field itself becomes an indictment: the system keeps making new problems while the heroes try to fix the old one. Run this scene as ordeal, ritual defense, and restoration: Market Correction is the system trying to restore profit logic over human safety. Keep the camera close to practical choices, visible consequences, and the difference between ordinary people and the infrastructure pressing on them.
- Read Aloud: The runes stutter. Somewhere under the soil, something old receives permission to continue.
- Gm Notes: Use only if the fight needs pressure or if a Soul-Audit Wraith module effect needs a fast enemy for countdown progress. Keep player-facing information actionable. Reveal systemic truth through objects, reactions, and consequences before naming it. Manufactured-threat lens: seed the contradiction, do not explain it. The surface goal stays simple and heroic.
- Sensory Details: coins ringing without falling green light turning red at the edges wind smelling like hot metal and wet paperwork
- Body Language: The Custodian is most vulnerable when the correction peaks Marlowe looks furious at a contract for the first time
- Sample Dialogue: Marlowe Fairwind There it is. Not a villain. Worse. A policy with teeth.
- Checks: Any heroic approach Break the correction's pressure through action, care, or sacrifice. Hard Determine strong or unstable ward outcome. 20 Cleanly resolve: Break the correction's pressure through action, care, or sacrifice. Add a concrete boon, extra clue, or improved position. Success, plus the player names one helpful detail or asks one follow-up question. Success, but the GM exposes a cost, ticks a countdown, or reveals a new pressure tied to Market Correction. The full goal slips, but the party still learns a useful truth or avoids the worst consequence. The GM makes a hard move that follows from the fiction and leaves the next choice visible. Spend Fear to tick the ritual countdown, expose the Custodian, activate ward backlash, or trigger Market Correction. On mixed or sliding results, reveal information in layers: visible fact, actionable clue, then systemic truth.
- Choices Consequences: Shield the Custodian Ward returns strong if enough support has been earned. Ward Stability strong. Chase every threat May save PCs but destabilize the line. Ward restored but trembling.
- Clues: Market Correction pulse The final threat is systemic. No boss monster owns the harm. The infrastructure reacts to care as inefficiency.
- Loot: Cold seal wax Humming stone chip Keystone Asset?: Inside the sealed crate, packed in wax-paper and reassurance, sits a heavy grey stone the size of a loaf, warm to the touch, faintly humming, with a light deep inside it that is slowly going out.

- Payoff Flags: Ward Stability Track
- Filters: act-five choice combat consequence corporate-satire-beat gm-only the-ward-renewal ward-stability-track manufactured-threat guaranteed-earned clue
- Index: 23
- Player Questions: What detail in Market Correction tells you the official story is incomplete? Who notices the human cost first, and how do they show it? What small object, smell, or sound makes this scene feel real?
- Relationship Prompts: Which PC quietly checks on someone else here? Who disagrees about the right thing to do without breaking trust?
- Ownership Prompt: Name one detail in Market Correction that belongs to your character's point of view.
- Reveal Hooks: Loreborne or Knowledge-focused PCs can read the institutional layer. Wildborne/community-focused PCs can read local custom and ecological stress. Martial/security-focused PCs can read threat posture and custody logic. Magic-focused PCs can feel ward tone, soul-signal, or spell instability. Loreborne: spots older legal, heraldic, or ward-craft language under the branding. Underborne: notices service doors, hidden routes, and who built the thing nobody credits. Highborne: reads etiquette, class panic, and reputational risk. Ridgeborne: notices stonework, weight, pressure, and structural weakness. Wildborne: reads the land, animals, and local ecological stress. Elf/Ribbet/Human/Giant/Katari: invite one sensory or social detail from the player's heritage. Sorcerer/Rogue/Warrior/Guardian/Ranger: give each class one table-facing way to shine without changing the plot.
- Fear Spends: Spend Fear to tick the ritual countdown, expose the Custodian, activate ward backlash, or trigger Market Correction. Tick the Ritual Countdown the wrong direction or expose the Custodian. Trigger Market Correction, Pass-Through, Memory Delve, or Group Attack when fiction supports it.
- Story Scope: Perceived antagonist: the forest. True antagonist: the corporate lie about the forest. The players never confront it directly. They are meant to feel it by the end. Every act offers at least one guaranteed and one earned hint that the danger is manufactured and the forest is not the enemy. Soul-Audit Wraiths bear audit glyphs and say, "Unlicensed soul-resonance detected. Submit for audit." REFLAVOR GUARANTEED A defeated wraith leaves a Soulspire compliance tag or coil-credit token instead of natural remains. ADD GUARANTEED Wraiths ignore forest creatures and home only on ritual soul-magic. ADD EARNED Instinct Medium 15 A player can read the markings and name Soulspire without the GM naming it first. ADD EARNED Knowledge Medium 15 Optional flag: Legacy Skeletons carry scraps of old corporate credentials. FLAG SEED Instinct: target logic. Knowledge: read markings. ACT5 Act 5: Open Vale defense 200 2:40 to 3:20 3:20 countdown 8, skeletons, wraiths, Market Correction Lower the countdown start to 6; cap wraith reinforcements.
- Mechanics: The party is in Act Five pressure: The environment produces more skeletons when pressure is needed. Use Daggerheart Duality Dice as baseline. Use the listed Difficulty and outcome options when a roll matters. Keep trivial actions no-roll; roll only when uncertainty, cost, or danger is interesting. s05-06-disrupt-market-correction S05-06 Disrupt Market Correction Disrupt Market Correction Knowledge Strength Knowledge Strength 14 Knowledge finds the rising pattern; Strength collapses the breach point. The environment keeps purchasing more threat. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress.

Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains Fear. Make a hard move that follows from the fiction. The environment keeps purchasing more threat. Use a hard...

- Roll Cards: s05-06-disrupt-market-correction S05-06 Disrupt Market Correction Disrupt Market Correction Knowledge Strength Knowledge Strength 14 Knowledge finds the rising pattern; Strength collapses the breach point. The environment keeps purchasing more threat. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains Fear. Make a hard move that follows from the fiction. The environment keeps purchasing more threat. Use a hard complication, lost time, worse position, GM Fear, or mark Stress. Apply an official condition only if the fiction and rules justify it. The attempt falls short, but a partial thread appears. Offer one clue, weak position, or safer follow-up. The PC gets the core result, but it costs time, noise...
- Conditions Hazards: Vulnerable
- Search Loot Clues: No fixed loot. Offer clue, texture, or hospitality only when the fiction supports it.
- No Roll Guidance: Do not call for a roll when the players have time, a clear method, and no meaningful pressure.
- Tv Mechanics Caption: Public cue: Market Correction asks what the party does, what it costs, and who is protected.
- Trait Variety Note: Primary traits in this scene: Finesse, Knowledge, Strength. If rolls drift toward Instinct/Presence, ask whether Agility, Strength, Finesse, or Knowledge better describes the action.
- Location Ids: open-valetm-ritual-site
- Item Ids: keystone-asset
- Clueids: corporate-seal-wax-residue market-correction
- Clue Ids: corporate-seal-wax-residue market-correction
- Image Asset Status: image_gen

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